



MONTHLY UPDATE

ICT Industry: monthly update, August 2026

Edition of 2026-09-01 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

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BOTSWANA · EGYPT · EQUATORIAL GUINEA · GABON · GHANA · MOROCCO · NIGER · NIGERIA · SOUTH AFRICA · TOGO · ZAMBIA

Botswana

The state wholesale network operator [presented its first integrated report, for the year ended 31 March 2025, at its annual general meeting on 13 August, with revenue down on the year, and reported its 2025/26 local access projects complete](#). Publishing an integrated report is itself part of the movement: the operator has not accounted for itself in one document before.

Egypt

A group inaugurated its Middle East and Africa regional headquarters and first global generative-AI centre of excellence in New Cairo on 28 July, backed by a company-stated US\$100m with about 800 staff ([inauguration account](#)).

Equatorial Guinea

Salvador Nguema Funtam took over at GITGE with a new deputy, the outcome of the July selection process.

The consultancy AVANTE brought public institutions, banks and technology firms to the Hotel Anda China in Malabo on 22 July with the backing of the national development agency ANDGE. Panellists included the ministry's director-general for artificial intelligence, GITGE's technical director and BANGE's deputy head of digital and electronic banking.

The base's first record of a national e-commerce platform arrived on 14 August, when the economy ministry and [SelBa24 met to organise the country's first e-commerce and digital-payments seminar-workshop](#), to run simultaneously in Malabo and Bata between September and October and to train SMEs, traders and farmers to open and run free online stores on the platform. Nothing about SelBa24 itself — its ownership, merchant count, transaction volume or launch date — is stated.

Gabon

A ride-hailing platform [began recruiting drivers at Libreville in partnership with a local transport operator, without announcing a launch date, the cities it will serve, its tariffs or its regulatory framework](#). It works as a pure intermediary with no fleet or drivers of its own, entering a market where one competitor has operated since 2021 and electric taxis were deployed in late 2025 under a state-backed project.

Ghana

On 27 July a company filed a writ claiming authorship of the 2007 design of the dominant mobile-money platform; the operator answered on 31 July that the claims are without merit and it will contest fully.

Morocco

The industry and trade ministry [added video games to the innovation funding programme](#), so companies in the sector can now apply for government funding to develop and test new games. No allocation, ceiling or first award has been published.

Niger

Hardware assembly is the one industrial position with a date attached. A government delegation inspecting the electronics plant at Hamdallaye [put it at 63 per cent complete and due in service by the end of October 2026, to assemble smartphones, computers and tablets](#). A completion percentage and a month are more than most rows in this report carry; what is absent is everything downstream of the building — capacity, cost, ownership and who buys the output.

Nigeria

[Mobile money revenue at the largest operator grew about 132% in the first half and active wallets rose 1.3 million to five million](#), while suspending a single airtime-lending product took second-quarter fintech revenue to ₦12.99bn, down 72.4% year on year — establishing that the book the market had read as a payments business was substantially an airtime-lending business.

South Africa

The sector's transformation body lost its chair. The communications minister [replaced the B-BBEE ICT Sector Council's chairperson and appointed an interim chair for six months](#) on 14 August, after a departmental investigation found the council dysfunctional. The investigation report is not published, and no remedial plan, terms of reference for the interim period or date for a permanent appointment is stated.

The informal economy became a data product. A listed payments company [began selling near-real-time item-level intelligence on informal retail, drawn from a point-of-sale network of over 90,000 spaza shops and taverns and 10,500 checkouts, to consumer-goods brands, wholesalers and financiers](#). The network figures are the company's own, and no consent basis or data-protection assessment for reselling merchant transaction data is stated.

Platform transport worked the other end of the same problem — getting drivers inside a licensing regime rather than getting data out of them. An e-hailing operator [took its compliance programme to the provinces, holding a North West regulatory engagement in Rustenburg on 18 August attended by more than 150 operators and a Western Cape transport dialogue in Cape Town on 21 August at which the provincial mobility department's director of licensing and adjudication undertook to add e-hailing as a service option on the operating-licence application; the North West provincial regulatory entity put its pending operating-licence backlog at 3,000 to 5,000 applications](#). The account is the platform's own and the undertaking is not yet an amended form.

Togo

[Fuel marking and traceability began at Lome](#), the obligation having applied since 1 July: every litre through legal channels carries a molecular marker verifiable at depot, station and roadside, with sanctions running to seizure, fines of FCFA 50,000 to 10,000,000 and closure. Neither the contract amendment nor the marking regulation is held, and no contract value, duration or data-ownership term is published.

Zambia

The third edition of a continental diversity report puts [29% of Zambian startups sampled with at least one female co-founder, the highest of any country covered, and 22.6% with a female chief executive](#), against a continental 19.2% female co-founded from a sample of more than 3,000. The underlying report is not held; only the trade-press account is.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-09-01
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/tech-industry/tech-industry-monthly.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/tech-industry/tech-industry-monthly-2026-09-01.pdf
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